

WHAT DOES IT ALL MEME?

YOU CANNOT KILL AN IDEA! OR CAN YOU?

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Technology being increasingly ever present, it's no overstatement to say everyone is on the internet these days, in some form or another. Okay, maybe not literally everyone considering most reports peg global internet penetration at about 50 percent. Still, we doubt any of those other 50 percent will be Digit readers, so for all practical purposes yes, everyone is online these days... but we digress. The reason we're bringing up the internet is to delve into the second most popular form of entertainment on the internet, and this month's theme - The 'Meme'. When Richard Dawkins coined the term in his book, *The Selfish Gene*, he didn't imagine that it would take up a life of its own. The meme has since evolved, and perhaps even slimmed down, considering where it stands today. Viral as they are today, will memes ever die?



THERE'S A MEME FOR THAT FOOL

If you haven't heard of the Meme, hold on, that's what this article is here for. On the other hand, if you're a 9gag regular and can identify every

meme by name, you may think you know it all but we're here to tell you that you don't - that's also what this article is here for. Clever eh? The old "All roads lead to Rome" meme. Or is it the 'Destiny' meme, the illusion of choice? We'll get to that. First, a formal definition:

MEME

noun

1. an element of a culture or system of behaviour passed from one individual to another by imitation or other non-genetic means.
2. an image, video, piece of text, etc., typically humorous in nature, that is copied and spread rapidly by Internet users, often with slight variations.

What most people think of when they read the word 'Meme' is the second definition, which is in fact a subset of the first. Today's Internet memes as you likely know them are sometimes gifs, and most often images with text overlays at the top and bottom, exclusively in the all caps Impact font style. These memes evolved - like most web phenomenon - in the 4chan crucible. Modern internet memes include text like "how

can she slap" to everything from videos to fake site links that get you Rickrolled. The videos could be popular and fun like Psy's record breaking Gangnam Style, or popular and distasteful like Rebecca Black's cringe



Eating with a spoon is a meme too

worthy Friday. Why limit ourselves to songs, even Richard Dawkins himself stars in a meme or two, where you can watch his amazing rebuttals to both stupid and intelligent questions.

Even as the first definition - the classical one - a meme is always in the form of information, whatever its substance, be it a ritual or the knowledge to make a katana. Without exception, memes are communicable, because of their form. The internet is a world composed entirely of information, so it is no surprise that is where most